

Satisfactory Academic Progress (SAP)

The institutional policy for determining whether a student enrolled in the program is making satisfactory academic progress (SAP);

ASTEP students may take classes for credit from the MSU or DCB course catalogs. Whether students are taking MSU or DCB classes for credit, they follow the DCB SAP policy because DCB remains their home institution.

Dakota College at Bottineau SAP Policy

Dakota College at Bottineau (DCB), in compliance with federal regulations, has established policies and procedures to ensure that all students are making Satisfactory Academic Progress (SAP) towards a degree, diploma or certificate. These standards must be met throughout all enrollment periods regardless of whether or not a student receives federal financial aid. These enrollment periods include the fall, spring and summer terms. In order to be eligible for federal student financial aid students must meet these standards or they are ineligible for federal aid until standards are met. The DCB SAP policy applies to credit degree seeking students enrolled in the ASTEP program as well. DCB's SAP policy is outlined below. The complete DCB SAP policy is available at [Satisfactory Progress Policy :: Dakota College at Bottineau](#)

Qualitative Academic Standards Grade Point Average (GPA)

At the end of each semester, all student GPAs are evaluated at DCB. In order to meet the GPA requirements, a student must have a cumulative grade point average of the following:

Minimum Cumulative GPA Required:

- 1st semester: 1.60
- 2nd semester: 1.75
- 3rd semester: 2.0
- 4th semester: 2.0

1. Quantitative Rate of Progress (pace)

Maximum Time Frame

Students enrolled at DCB are eligible to receive federal student aid within 150% of the published program length required to complete their declared program. For example, if a program required 60 credits to complete, a student would be allowed 90 attempted credits ($60 \times 150\% = 90$). Students who have attempted 125% of their program credits will receive a financial aid informational notice via email. Students who have attempted 150% of their program credits will receive a notice of disqualification via email. The approximate maximum credit guidelines are as follows and may vary depending on the program:

- One Year Program: 45 credits
- Two Year Program: 90 credits

2. Completion of Attempted Credits

In order to maintain Satisfactory Academic Progress for federal financial aid purposes, undergraduate students must complete a minimum of two-thirds (or 66.67%) of the credits attempted each semester and cumulatively. This percentage is calculated by dividing the total number of successfully completed credits by the total number of credits registered on financial aid census date.

The financial aid census date is the first day after the last day to drop/add classes at a 100% refund, this is the date the financial aid office uses to lock in the enrollment status. This corresponds with the 8.99% of the semester where a student is able to withdraw at 100%. The cumulative credits calculations include all credits attempted even if they do not pertain to the current degree.

Students who are not meeting one or more of the Satisfactory Academic Progress (SAP) requirements will receive a Satisfactory Academic Progress Warning notice from the Financial Aid Office. If at the end of the next semester, the student is not in compliance with the SAP policy then the student will be notified being on satisfactory academic progress disqualification. Students have the right to appeal the disqualification by submitting an appeal to the financial aid committee. Students will not receive any federal financial aid while they are Financial Aid Disqualified. A participant may be terminated from the program if the student has not progressed satisfactorily.

Proposed SAP Policy for ASTEP's College-to-Career Certificate

Measure of Academic Progress in C2C Coursework for Credit

For those ASTEP students who are taking their C2C coursework for credit, SAP will be determined by a satisfactory grade point average (GPA) of at least 2.0 (as required for all students). ASTEP students who are taking their classes for credit will be expected to meet the course objectives at the same level as their college peers and will be graded on the same scale as their classmates. Based on ADA requirements, ASTEP students will be eligible for reasonable accommodations if they do not alter the course content or grading standards. In addition to satisfactory progress in academics, ASTEP students are also required to demonstrate satisfactory performance (with a rating of at least "expected progress" on their goals) in their work-based training, independent living, and social engagement (as described in subsequent sections).

Measure of Academic Progress in C2C Coursework for Audit

The minimum Grade Point Average (GPA) and rate of completion requirements will not apply to non-degree seeking ASTEP students who are auditing classes. Instead, individualized academic goals for these students will be developed through ASTEP's collaborative PCP process with the student, faculty members, and academic coordinator. Academic goals will be recorded on a learning contract based on goals and expectations for the class (as previously referenced and found in Appendix E). Progress is monitored using feedback rubrics (Appendix F and G) that are

completed by mentors following each academic shift and by faculty members at the middle and end of the semester. As another measure for monitoring performance, the Academic Coordinator will receive notices through an early alert system that MSU/DCB faculty members use to communicate academic and attendance concerns.

In addition, a goal attainment scale (GAS) (Tennant, 2007) is used to monitor progress on each student's individualized goals. Through the GAS process, student progress on their goals is rated on a 1-5 Likert scale. For each of the students' individualized goals, there are measurable benchmarks that correspond to progress based on the following scale: (1) much less than expected progress; (2) less than expected progress; (3) expected progress; (4) greater than expected progress; and (5) much greater than expected progress. As an example, a student who is learning to participate in class discussions might receive a "1" if s/he did not attempt to participate at all during the semester, a "3" if s/he participated in class discussions with prompts from an academic mentor, and a "5" if the student independently participated in class discussions throughout the semester. To maintain SAP, ASTEP students must have an average rating of at least "expected progress" across all of their course goals. A sample GAS rubric for an audited course is included in Appendix K.

Feedback on the academic progress rubrics will be reviewed daily by the Academic Coordinator and used to make data-driven decisions about accommodations, supports, and adequate completion of core curriculum requirements. Using the feedback forms and rubrics referenced above to determine progress, the Academic Coordinator will generate a report at the end of each semester identifying students who are not meeting SAP. This report will be submitted to the DCB Vice President for Academic Affairs and Office of Financial Aid.

ASTEP's Steps for Addressing Inadequate Progress

In addition to the Institute of Higher Education (IHE) procedures for addressing inadequate academic progress, ASTEP will also implement its own three-step process (as shown in Table 5) to provide remedial supports for students who are not making SAP.

Table 5: Remediation Steps for Inadequate SAP

Steps	Remediation Measures
First Meeting	• Meet with student, faculty member and academic coordinator. • Discuss strategies for improving academic performance. • Modify learning contract goals if necessary. • Identify additional accommodations through Access Services. • Develop and implement formal plan for improvement with action steps, supports needed, individuals responsible, and timelines.
Second Meeting	• Meet with student, parents, academic coordinator, and ASTEP project director. • Review plan for improvement. • Modify plan based on team recommendations.

Third Meeting	• Meet with student, parents, academic coordinator, and ASTEP project director. • Determine if class needs to be dropped or retaken in another semester.
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If an ASTEP student is enrolled in a combination of courses (some for credit and others for audit), the standard GPA method for determining satisfactory academic progress (minimum GPA of 2.0) will be used in classes taken for credit. For classes in which a student is auditing, the GAS rubric method will be used to monitor adequate progress on individualized goals.

Measure of Progress in Other Adult Life Domains

Like academics, ASTEP students must demonstrate satisfactory performance in the employment, independent living, and social domains for successful completion of the C2C.

Employment

ASTEP students are required to complete nine hours of work-based training over the course of the three-year program. In each work-based training experience, students must demonstrate at least expected progress toward their employment goals as outlined in their individualized PCP. Progress will be measured by the Employment Coordinator using GAS ratings and task analytic data. Feedback from employers that is collected at the mid-point and end of the semester will also be used to assess progress. In addition, the feedback forms that are completed by the mentors who provide job coaching after each employment shift are also reviewed daily by the ASTEP Employment Coordinator as part of the process for tracking progress and addressing concerns as they arise.

Independent Living

To meet the ASTEP requirements, students must complete a minimum of one hour of independent living training per week each semester during their three-year program. Following each independent living training session, peer partners complete a feedback form (Appendix G) that each students' ASTEP advisor reviews to monitor progress on independent living goals. Like employment, ASTEP students must demonstrate at least expected progress toward their independent living goals based on GAS ratings, completion of task analysis steps, and mentor feedback.

Social Engagement

ASTEP students engage in campus life events with other undergraduate students for at least one hour per week each semester during their three-year program. Campus engagement includes eating in the cafeteria, participating in recreation activities in the student center, completing fitness activities in the wellness center, and attending campus-wide events such as music/theater productions, athletic activities, movies, and organized games such as Bingo and Minute to Win It. While progress monitoring on social engagement is less structured than academics or employment, mentors still complete a feedback form (Appendix J as previously referenced) following each social shift that is reviewed by students' advisor.

Repeated Coursework

Any courses that a student repeats as part of the ASTEP core curriculum will be subject to MSU/DCB policies for repeated coursework. These policies are shown in Table 6.

Table 6: MSU and DCB Repeated Coursework Policies

Institution	Policy
Minot State University More information can be found at: https://www.minotstateu.edu/finaid/_documents/policies/policy_repeated_coursework.pdf	- Regulations prevent the Financial Aid Office from paying for a course that has been repeated more than one time. - In order for a repeated course to be counted towards enrollment status for financial aid purposes, a previously passed course may only be repeated once (a total of two attempts). - If a student enrolls in a previously repeated and passed course for a third time, this course will not count towards enrollment for financial aid purposes.
Dakota College at Bottineau More information can be found at: https://www.dakotacollege.edu/admissions-financial-aid/policies/satisfactory-progress-policy	- Repeated coursework does count into attempted credit calculations and the most recent grade counts into GPA. - Any course that was previously passed that is being retaken for a higher grade may only qualify for Financial Aid one additional time. - Failed courses may be repeated and paid with financial aid until passed as long as the student is still otherwise eligible for the funding.

3) The number of weeks of instructional time and the number of semester or quarter credit hours or clock hours in the program, including the equivalent credit or clock hours associated with noncredit or reduced credit courses or activities;

ASTEP follows a traditional semester with 16 weeks of instructional time based upon the MSU/DCB academic calendar. To meet the C2C requirements, students take classes for credit or audit and complete work-based training experiences. Combined, students complete at least six credit hours of inclusive academic coursework and work-based training each semester which is considered half time enrollment.

As referenced previously, a sample curriculum for ASTEP's full three-year College to Career Certificate program of study is shown in Appendix B.

In summary, the minimum requirements for ASTEP's C2C include:

1. Twenty-nine credit hours of inclusive coursework – either taken for credit or audited, are required for completion of the C2C certificate. The C2C course of study is individualized based on students' PCP goals. For audited coursework, assignments are modified to reflect

both course content and career/life goals and progress on learning contract goals is measured for satisfactory academic progress (SAP).

2. Nine-credit hours of inclusive work-based training is required for completion of the C2C Certificate. Work-based training experiences are related to each students' career interest areas and PCP goals and include job shadowing, paid and unpaid internships, and paid employment. Work-based training takes place at community and campus worksites alongside individuals who do not have disabilities.

3. Three-credit hours of independent living training is another requirement of the C2C certificate and is designed to enhance students' skills in areas such preparing meals, maintaining personal belongings and living spaces, managing money, and using community services such as public transportation, grocery stores, restaurants, banks, etc.

4. Three-credit hours of social skills training is the final requirement for the C2C certificate and includes supporting students to engage in campus life events, clubs, and volunteer opportunities alongside other college students who do not have disabilities.

4) A description of the educational credential offered (e.g., degree or certificate) or identified outcome or outcomes established by the institution for all students enrolled in the program;

The College-to-Career Certificate (C2C) is the educational credential that MSU/DCB will offer through its CTP. Based on individualized PCP, the ASTEP C2C Certificate is designed to provide an inclusive college program of study that leads to gainful employment for students with ID.

In addition to meeting ASTEP's academic requirements, it is anticipated that students will achieve the following adult life domain outcomes upon completion of the C2C Certificate.

- Employment – ASTEP students who complete the C2C Certificate will have skills for gainful employment including job seeking skills, task-specific skills, specialty skills for a particular career path, and essential related skills. These students will be better equipped for the world of work.
- Independent Living –ASTEP students will learn skills for daily living and caring for themselves and their belongings. Because of this, students will be prepared to live more independently after they graduate from ASTEP.
- Recreation/Leisure – ASTEP students will gain skills for participating in a variety of activities to occupy their discretionary time.
- Social – Through engagement in campus life activities, ASTEP students will acquire skills for interpersonal relationships, friendships, and interactions with others.
- Self-Determination and Advocacy – By embedding opportunities for self-determination and advocacy in all of the components of ASTEP, students will develop skills for making personal choices/decisions and speaking and acting on behalf of themselves.
- Miscellaneous – Through training in a variety of additional areas, ASTEP students' communication, self-esteem, fitness, and health and wellness skills will be enhanced.

These outcomes will extend beyond the college setting into all aspects of adult life following completion of the C2C Certificate by ASTEP students.



Satisfactory Academic Progress (SAP) Signature

I have reviewed the Satisfactory Academic Progress (SAP) to be a student with ASTEP, at Dakota College Bottineau, and at Minot State University.

Student Signature

Date

Parent/Guardian Signature

Date